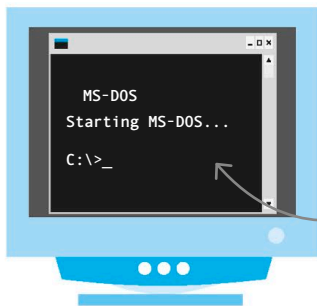


Personal computers

Personal computers started appearing in the late 1970s when several basic models went on sale. One of these machines was made by Apple Computers, a company started by Steve Jobs, Steve Wozniak, and Ronald Wayne in 1976. One year earlier, Bill Gates and Paul Allen had founded Microsoft, developing operating system software that allowed users to interact with various personal computers.

▷ Apple II

Personal computers, such as the Apple II, were mainly aimed at small businesses and amateur electronics fans.



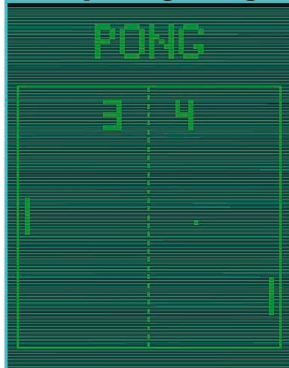
◁ Microsoft Disc Operating System (MS-DOS)

MS-DOS is the basic operating system developed by Microsoft for personal computers.

MS-DOS's command-line interface.

REAL WORLD

Computer gaming



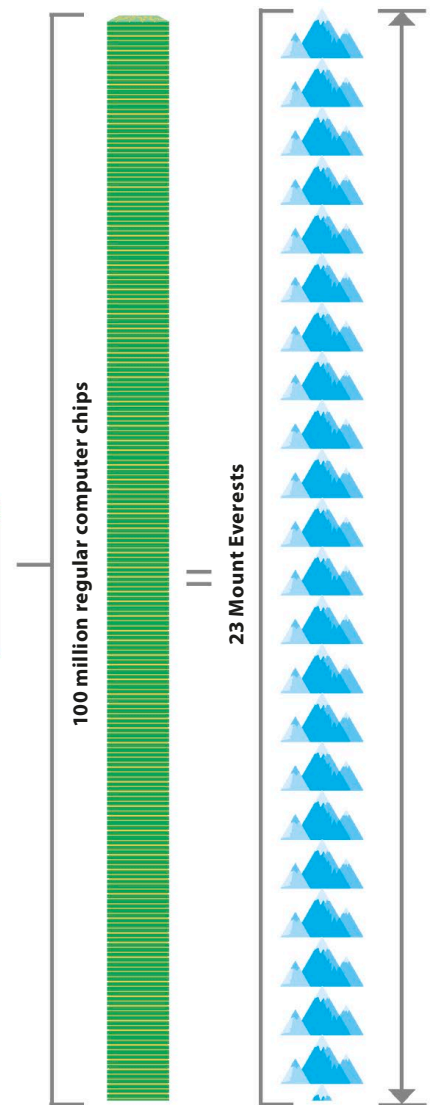
One factor that greatly popularized home computers and programming was computer gaming. The first commercially available computer game was Pong, a simple table-tennis style game, brought out in 1972. Originally played on machines in arcades, a home console version was released by the American company Atari in 1975.

Supercomputers

Most computers work through a problem from start to finish using one processor to do the calculations. The first really powerful supercomputers appeared in the 1990s. They have many individual processors working on lots of tiny parts of a big problem at the same time. These computers are used for tasks such as weather forecasting, designing aircraft engines, and breaking coded messages.



Quantum computer chip



△ D-wave quantum chip

The D-wave quantum supercomputer has the same processing power as 100 million regular computers. If 100 million computer chips were stacked on top of each other, they would be the same height as 23 Mount Everests.